At just about this time, too, advance copies of Second Foundation arrived, and now the entire Foundation series was in book form.

I was grateful to Marty Greenberg for putting out the Foundation series as well as I, Robot when no one else seemed interested in doing it —and on the whole he had produced attractive volumes.

It was quite clear by now, however, after three years of doing busi-

ness with him, that he was extremely slow in paying even the smallest sums and that he did not produce the kind of statements that the contracts called for. I never knew how many copies of my books he sold so that I could at least know how much in debt to me he was. The situation looked worse when I compared it with the efficient and businesslike way in which Doubleday produced all statements in full detail, and all checks with prompt readiness.

My gratitude to Marty meant that I remained friends with him despite his laggardness in payment and bookkeeping and that I did not unreasonably dun him for money or grow unreasonably annoyed when he came up with one more ingeniously innocent reason for not being able to pay till month after next. My gratitude was not sufficient, however, to induce me to give him any more books. Second Foundation was the fourth and last book of mine to appear under the Gnome Press imprint.

Marty was annoyed at this at lunch, once, when it became clear he wasn't getting any more books from me, he said, rather violently, that it was a clear understanding between us that I was to alternate books between himself and Doubleday.

There was no such understanding at all, of course, though that was the way it had happened for four years, but I didn't argue the point. I simply said, "Where are the statements for the four books you now have?" and Marty changed the subject and never brought it up again.

4

On May 25, 1953, I fell prey to the social conformity of the 1950s and got myself a short haircut. It was not a crew cut, such as Lemon wore, but it was short enough (like Walker's) not to require combing.

The not-combing bit was a great relief, for even today I am no better at combing than I had been at Seth Low. I did not, however, like my short-hair appearance. I let my hair grow back to its usual length and never cut it short